

Hearth — Implementation Spec

Hearth: the warm center of a home people gather around — a hub for practitioners and conscious events in our community.

Purpose: This document describes, in detail, how the Hearth community hub is built and operated. The hub has two layers in one website: a **practitioner directory** and a **beautiful, phone-friendly view of upcoming community events**. It is written so that an AI assistant (or a developer) can use it to build everything, while remaining readable for Anat or Curtis if they'd like to see the inner workings.

Status: Draft for review. Categories, form fields, and copy are starting points meant to be refined.

1. Overview & principles

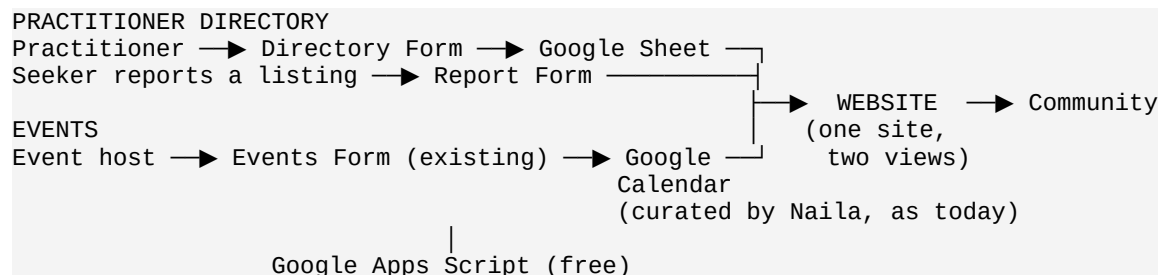
A free, low-maintenance, phone-first website that does two things in one place:

- **Find practitioners** — a searchable directory of healers, therapists, facilitators, and conscious businesses in our community.
- **See what's happening** — a clean, easy-to-read list of upcoming conscious events, pulled live from the community Google Calendar (much friendlier than the calendar itself on a phone).

Design principles:

- **Free forever** — only tools with genuinely free tiers, no surprise paywalls.
- **No login** — no accounts or passwords for anyone, submitting or browsing.
- **Two layers, one home** — practitioners and events live together, so people coming for one discover the other.
- **Reuse what already works** — events keep flowing through the existing events form and calendar; nothing changes for event hosts or for Naila.
- **Open posting, community-policed** — anyone can add a listing instantly; the community flags problems; a human only steps in on flagged items.
- **Non-technical to operate** — all day-to-day content lives in Google Forms, a Google Sheet, and the existing Google Calendar that a non-technical steward can run. A developer is only needed for the initial build and rare redesigns.
- **Mobile-first** — most members live on WhatsApp on their phones, so the experience is designed for a phone screen first.

2. Architecture (how the pieces connect)



- content checks on new listings
- counts distinct reporters
- emails Anat/Curtis when a listing crosses the flag threshold

Data flow in words:

- *Directory*: practitioners submit through a Google Form → a Google Sheet. The website reads the sheet live and renders the directory. The site never writes data, so there is no server to maintain and no open database to attack.
- *Events*: event hosts keep using the **existing** events Google Form, which feeds the **existing** community Google Calendar (curated by Naila exactly as today). The website reads that public calendar and displays upcoming events as beautiful, mobile-friendly cards. We change nothing about how events are added — we just present them better.

3. Tech stack (all free)

Layer	Tool	Why / notes
Directory submissions	Google Forms	Free, unlimited responses, built-in spam protection, familiar.
Directory data store	Google Sheets	Free. Published read-only so the website can read it. Data is public by design.
Events input	Existing events Google Form	Unchanged — hosts already use it.
Events data store	Existing Google Calendar	Unchanged — curated by Naila. Must be public for the site to read it (it already is, since members view it).
Reading the sheet	Sheets "Publish to web" (CSV) or the gviz JSON endpoint	No API key needed for a public sheet. ~5-min cache (fine).
Reading the calendar	Google Calendar API v3 (<code>events.list</code> with an API key)	Free, ~1M requests/day. Works for public calendars with no login. API key is restricted to our site's domain. Supports browser (CORS) requests.
Events rendering	FullCalendar.js (open source) or a custom card list	Free. FullCalendar has a built-in Google Calendar source; or we render our own pretty "upcoming" list.
Website hosting	Cloudflare Pages / Netlify / GitHub Pages	Free static hosting; nothing to maintain server-side.

Automation	Google Apps Script	Free, runs inside the sheet. Content checks, reporter dedupe, notifications.
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Cost ceiling: \$0. None of the hub's needs (a few hundred listings, a calendar of events, a few hundred visitors) come close to any free-tier limit.

Note on the calendar API key: in a static site the key is visible in the page, which is normal and safe for a *public, read-only* calendar — we restrict the key to our site's domain so it can't be reused elsewhere. (Alternative if we ever want to avoid an API key entirely: read events from the events form's response sheet, the same way we read the directory. Trade-off: that wouldn't reflect Naila's manual curation, so reading the calendar is preferred.)

4. The practitioner submission form

Google Form, kept short. Fields:

1. **Your name** (*short text, required*)
 2. **Practice or business name** (*short text, optional — defaults to your name*)
 3. **Category** (*dropdown / checkboxes, required — see Section 5*) — allow selecting up to 2–3.
 4. **Short description of what you offer** (*paragraph, required, ~300 characters*)
 5. **Area / location** (*short text, required*) — e.g., "Oakville," "Toronto + online."
 6. **How do you work?** (*multiple choice, required*) — In person / Online / Both.
 7. **Best way to reach you** (*required — at least one of:*) WhatsApp number / Email / Website or social link.
 8. **Are you a member of the community group?** (*yes/no, required*) — light trust signal.
 9. **Optional: a photo or logo link** (*short text*)
 10. **Optional: pricing note** (*short text*) — e.g., "sliding scale available."
 11. **Community agreement** (*checkbox, required*) — "I offer this in good faith and agree to the community's spirit of respect and care."
- Keep it to one screen. Every extra field lowers completion.

5. Category taxonomy (starter set)

Designed for this community; expandable as people sign up.

- **Bodywork & Massage** — massage therapy, deep tissue, Thai, lymphatic, reflexology
- **Somatic & Movement** — somatic therapy, dance/movement, yoga, breathwork, Qigong
- **Energy Healing** — Reiki, energetic alignment, sound healing, crystal healing
- **Manual & Physical Therapies** — osteopathy, chiropractic, physiotherapy, acupuncture
- **Mental & Emotional Wellbeing** — counselling, coaching, psychotherapy, hypnotherapy
- **Ceremony & Plant Medicine** (*where legal*) — cacao ceremonies, medicine people, facilitators
- **Spiritual Guidance** — astrology, tarot, intuitive readings, shamanic practice

- **Nutrition & Herbalism** — holistic nutrition, herbalism, Ayurveda
 - **Classes, Workshops & Facilitation** — workshop facilitators, retreat organisers, teachers
 - **Creative & Expressive Arts** — art therapy, music, voice
 - **Conscious Business & Other** — eco/ethical products, services that don't fit above
- Anat & Curtis to review and adjust; categories can grow over time (e.g., "medicine people" was specifically requested).

6. Google Sheet structure

Tab 1 — `Listings` (fed by the directory form; one row per practitioner):

Column	Source	Notes
Timestamp	auto	submission time
Name	form	
Practice name	form	
Category	form	one or more
Description	form	
Area	form	
Mode	form	in person / online / both
WhatsApp	form	
Email	form	
Website/social	form	
Member?	form	yes/no
Photo link	form	optional
Pricing note	form	optional
Status	script/manual	Live (default) or Hidden. Website shows only Live.
Auto-check	script	OK or Needs review (Section 7)
Distinct flags	script	count of unique reporters
Notes	manual	steward notes

Tab 2 — `Reports` (fed by the report form; one row per flag): Timestamp · Listing reported · Reporter email/WhatsApp (for dedupe) · Reason · Details.

7. Moderation & flagging logic

Model: **open posting → automated check → instant publish → community reporting → human only when needed.** No listing is ever auto-punished.

At submission (automatic, free): Apps Script content-checks each new listing — banned words, spam patterns (e.g., many URLs), required-field completeness. Clean rows go **Live** immediately; suspicious rows are marked **Needs review** and email the steward. (Optional stricter mode: hold **Needs review** rows as **Hidden** until a human approves — Anat's call.)

Reporting (community as the eyes):

- A "Report a listing" link opens the report form, which asks for the reporter's email or WhatsApp number — a field, **not** a login.
- Apps Script **counts distinct reporters per listing** (deduped by contact). One person = one flag, regardless of how many times they submit.
- **Flags never change a listing automatically.** Crossing a threshold of *distinct* reporters (suggested: 3) emails Anat/Curtis to take a look; a human decides whether to set **Status = Hidden**.
- **No public flag count** is shown — reporting is private. Nothing to brigade, no public shaming.
- **Reporter-pattern check:** if one reporter is flagging many different listings, the script notes it — that pattern points to the reporter, whose flags can be discounted.

Why this resists abuse: a disgruntled person can't inflate a count (deduped) and can't trigger an automatic consequence (human decides). Honest limit: with no real accounts, nothing free is fully sybil-proof, but for a ~550-person trust-based community this is more than enough.

Removal / edit requests: a practitioner contacts the steward, who edits the sheet. Low volume at this scale.

8. The events layer

Goal: show upcoming community events in a warm, mobile-friendly format that's far easier to scan than Google Calendar on a phone — without changing how events are added.

Input (unchanged): Event hosts continue to use the existing events Google Form, which adds events to the community Google Calendar, curated by Naila exactly as today. No new admin work is created.

Reading the events: The website fetches upcoming events from the public community calendar via the **Google Calendar API** (`events.list`, single API key, `timeMin = now`, ordered by start time, limited to e.g. the next ~30–60 events). No login for viewers.

Display:

- Default **"Upcoming" list view** — a clean vertical feed of event cards, each showing: title, date & time, location (in person/online), short description, and a "View / RSVP" or source link if present.
- Grouping by day or week ("This week," "Next week," "Later").
- Optional **month grid view** (via FullCalendar) for those who want the traditional calendar layout.
- A clear **"Add an event" button** linking to the existing events form, so the hub also drives event submissions.

Honesty note: the calendar must remain public (it already is). Event detail fields shown depend on what's captured today; if hosts don't enter a location or description, those simply don't appear. We can suggest small tweaks to the events form later to enrich the cards, but it's not required for v1.

9. The website (one site, two views)

Type: single-page, static, mobile-first. Reads the published Listings sheet and the public calendar live.

Look & feel: clean and calm, consistent with the community's WhatsApp aesthetic — soft greens/whites, rounded cards, generous spacing, friendly type. Warm and uncluttered, not corporate.

Top-level navigation (two tabs + a home):

- **Home** — a short welcome line, plus a peek at both worlds: a few featured/just-added practitioners and the next handful of upcoming events, each linking into its full view.
- **Practitioners (Directory):**
 - Search bar (name, description, category) + tappable category filter chips + In person/Online/Both filter.
 - **Listing cards:** name/practice, category tag(s), description, area + mode, contact buttons ("Message on WhatsApp" via wa.me, Email, Website), optional photo.
 - Prominent "Add your practice" button → directory Google Form.
 - Subtle "Report a listing" link → report form.
- **Events:**
 - "Upcoming" card feed grouped by day/week, with optional month grid view.
 - "Add an event" button → existing events form.

Footer: one line that this is a volunteer community resource + a short community-guidelines note.

Behaviour notes: only Status = Live listings display; data refreshes on page load (subject to Google's ~5-min cache and calendar API freshness); fully responsive, phone-first; no tracking, no ads, no accounts.

10. The report form (fields)

Short Google Form: (1) Which listing are you reporting? (2) Your email or WhatsApp number (*required — counts unique reports; not shown publicly*) (3) Reason (*Spam / Inappropriate / Not a real practitioner / Wrong or outdated info / Other*) (4) Anything else? (*optional*).

11. Automation summary (Google Apps Script)

One script bound to the directory sheet, free, no server: (1) on new listing → content checks → set Auto-check, email steward if needed; (2) on new report → recount distinct reporters → update Distinct flags, email Anat/Curtis if threshold crossed; (3) optional weekly digest of new listings and pending reviews. (*Events need no automation — they flow through the existing calendar.*)

12. Operating model & handoff

- **Day-to-day:** runs itself. Directory listings post automatically; events flow through the existing calendar. The steward is pinged only for flagged/suspicious listings.
- **Steward role:** Bhavna initially, then a community steward (like Naila for the calendar). About a minute, only when prompted.
- **No tech dependency for operations:** listings are managed in the Google Sheet; events in the existing Google Calendar. A developer is needed only for the initial build and rare redesigns.
- **Linking from WhatsApp:** the hub is shared as a single link in the relevant channel(s), and — under Option A — pinned in a dedicated practitioner WhatsApp group alongside the "add yourself" form.

13. Build checklist (for whoever builds it)

12. Create the **directory Google Form** (Section 4) linked to a new **Google Sheet**; set up tabs/columns (Section 6).
13. Create the **report form** (Section 10) feeding a Reports tab.
14. Write the **Apps Script** (Section 11): content checks, reporter dedupe, threshold notifications.
15. **Publish the `Listings` sheet** (CSV) or use the gviz endpoint.
16. Confirm the **community Google Calendar is public**; get its calendar ID; create a **restricted Calendar API key**.
17. Build the **static site** (Section 9): Home, Practitioners, Events views.
 - Directory view reads the sheet (search, filters, contact buttons).
 - Events view reads the calendar via the API (upcoming card feed + optional month grid), with an "Add an event" button to the existing form.
18. Deploy to free static hosting (Cloudflare Pages / Netlify / GitHub Pages).
19. Test end-to-end: submit a listing → it appears; file 3 reports → dedupe + notification fire; confirm upcoming events render correctly from the calendar.
20. Hand over: short "how to run it" note for the steward.

Open questions for Anat & Curtis: final category list; flag threshold (suggested 3 distinct reporters); whether suspicious listings publish instantly or wait for review; events default view (list vs. month grid); and whether to lightly enrich the events form fields later.